

"We have an honest and plainspeaking approach to negotiations. Countries today trust Prime Minister Narendra Modi to give them a fair deal and recognise that India is a trusted partner"

Q. Critics also allege that compromises in agriculture have been made in the US deal. Is it true?
We have not compromised on agriculture at all. There is absolutely no compromise on a variety of products that are sensitive in the Indian context. It's a win-win.

Q. What about soybeans and apples?
We have not opened to soybean or soybean meal. We do import soybean oil; we have been doing so since the time of the Congress governments. We also import fruits from America and other countries. It gives consumers more options, like they get better-quality apples than the ones we get from Turkey. So, giving a concession there is a zero-sum game.

Q. India has agreed to eliminate or reduce most favoured nation (MFN) tariffs on all US industrial goods, but the US has not done the same; it has only reduced reciprocal tariffs. Why has India made permanent tariff concessions in exchange for tariffs that Washington itself calls conditional and reversible?
Two things. First of all, we have not reduced tariffs on all industrial goods to zero. In some cases, tariffs will be calibrated over time; in others, we have laid down quotas. And where we have no sensitivity and need imports to develop our economy, like NVIDIA chips, we have allowed them. So, it's a very calibrated, well-thought-out, item-wise approach. Point two, the reciprocal tariffs are for real and the whole world has negotiated on them. We have got an understanding with the United States that, should the reciprocal tariffs be taken off for everybody, we too will have the opportunity to recalibrate our concessions. So, it's a very well-understood and balanced relationship. And I must say, the American negotiators are very fair.

Q. What about India's intent to buy $500 billion worth of US